BOOKLESSS — INTERNAL

Revenue Model & Growth Plan

Pricing structure, profitability thresholds, course rollout sequence, and team economics

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OVERVIEW

What This Model Is Built On

Booklesss delivers branded PDF study materials for Zambian university students through a Slack workspace. Revenue comes from two sources: full member subscriptions for workspace access, and per-course guest subscriptions. The model is built around Slack Business+ — one paid member seat unlocks five free single-channel guest slots.

Each course is structured across roughly four content channels plus shared support channels — announcements, general, and Q&A. Full members get access to everything: all course channels, all support channels, every course running on the platform. Guests are single-channel — they access one content channel at a time and are excluded from support channels. When a guest finishes a topic, they submit a request to be moved to the next channel. Students who want simultaneous access to all channels upgrade to K390 full members, which adds K51 markup per seat rather than guest revenue. The 330-slot guest pool is filled by single-course students at K195 each, producing up to K64,350/month per course at full capacity.

This document is the financial reference model. Actual performance is tracked against these projections monthly. Deviations in conversion rate, guest count, or overhead timing should be noted and the relevant phase thresholds recalculated.

PRICING

Subscription Rates

Tier	Rate	Slack type	Access	Net to platform
Full member	K390/month	Paid seat	All channels	K51 markup (seat costs K339)
Guest	K195/month	Single-channel guest	One channel at a time — sequential progression, no support channels	K195 — no Slack cost

Exchange rate: K18.82 per USD. Guest rate is half the full member rate. Guests stay at K195 for one month, then upgrade to K390 or leave. The K51 markup (K390 − K339 seat cost) is platform revenue only — it does not enter the guest revenue split.

> Guest channel model:
> Each course runs across roughly 4 content channels plus shared support channels (announcements, general, Q&A;). Guests access one content channel at a time and are excluded from support channels. When a guest completes a topic, they submit a request to be moved to the next channel — the admin reassigns them within their existing guest slot. Full members get immediate access to all channels across all courses.

> **66 full members from the launch campaign × K51 = K3,366/month fixed markup income before a single guest joins. K3,366 exceeds Phases 1 (K1,054), 2 (K1,430), and 3 (K2,936) overhead — the platform is profitable through Phase 3 from day 1 with zero guests.**

ACQUISITION

Campaign Math

The campaign targets full paying members. A K10,000 budget covers both flyer printing at K10 per flyer and a K50 commission paid to the campus distributor for each student who signs up and pays. At a 10% conversion rate that yields 66 full members. Their 66 seats unlock 330 single-channel guest slots across the workspace.

> **Cost per flyer: K10 print + (10% × K50 commission) = K15 total per flyer**
>
> **K10,000 ÷ K15 = 666 flyers distributed**
>
> **666 × 10% conversion = 66 full members**
>
> **66 members × 5 guest slots = 330 guest slots unlocked**
>
> **Guest slots = single-course students only (1 slot = 1 student in 1 channel)**
>
> **330 guests × K195 = K64,350/month guest revenue ceiling per course**
>
> **Multi-course students upgrade to K390 full member — adds K51 markup, no slot used**

Recruiting 50 students who each take multiple courses is far easier than recruiting 200 separate people. The multi-course model lowers the acquisition target without changing the revenue ceiling.

REVENUE STRUCTURE

How Money Flows

Guest revenue moves through two stages. First, 5% comes off the top as team welfare — covering data, meals, and transport for the course team. The remaining 95% splits three ways: 20% goes directly into the marketing campaign fund, 60% goes to the course team, and 20% goes to the platform. Every rand that flows through the campaign fund buys flyers at K15 effective cost and converts to new full members at 10% — the team is funding their own growth.

> **Guest revenue**
>
> **– 5% welfare (data, meals, transport)**
>
> **= distributable revenue**
>
> **→ Marketing fund 20% → campaign (K37.05 per student)**
>
> **→ Course team 60%**
>
> **→ Platform 20%**
>
> **Platform total = Platform 20% of distributable + K3,366 full member markup**
>
> **Platform net = Platform total – Overhead**
>
> **Campaign total = Platform net + Marketing fund (all reinvested)**

The course team's 60% is never touched by overhead. The platform bears all fixed costs from its 20% share plus the markup. The team earns from the first guest — and the platform is already profitable before the first guest ever joins.

OVERHEAD

Cost Phases

Overhead is structured in four phases. With K3,366/month in markup from 66 full members, Phases 1, 2, and 3 are all active from launch — the markup alone covers them. Only Phase 4 requires guest revenue to unlock, and break-even is 30 guests. All manager costs are platform overhead, never deducted from the team's share.

Phase	Trigger	New cost	Overhead
1 — Launch	Course opens	Founder Slack K339 + Founder Claude K376 + Manager Slack K339	K1,054
2 — Activate	Launch (day 1)	+ Manager Claude $20 (K376) — markup covers it immediately	K1,430
3 — Scale	Launch (day 1)	+ Founder Claude upgrade to $100 (+K1,506) — markup covers it immediately	K2,936
4 — Full build	30 guests	+ Manager Claude upgrade to $100 (+K1,506)	K4,442

PROFITABILITY

Full Model by Guest Count

Table A shows what the course team earns at each guest count (60% of distributable). Table B shows what the platform earns, including the K3,366/month fixed markup from 66 full members. Phases 1, 2, and 3 are profitable at zero guests. Phase 4 breaks even at 30 guests. ✓ marks the first row where each phase covers its overhead.

Table A — Team Earnings (per course, per month)

Phases 1, 2 & 3 — overhead K2,936 | all active from launch

Guests	Revenue	Welfare 5%	Team 60%
0 ✓	K0	K0	K0
10	K1,950	K98	K1,112
20	K3,900	K195	K2,223
30	K5,850	K293	K3,335

Phase 4 — overhead K4,442 | upgrade manager Claude at 30 guests

Guests	Revenue	Welfare 5%	Team 60%
30 ✓	K5,850	K293	K3,335
50	K9,750	K488	K5,557
100	K19,500	K975	K11,115
330 max	K64,350	K3,218	K36,680

Table B — Platform Economics (per course, per month)

Phases 1, 2 & 3 — overhead K2,936 | profitable at 0 guests

Guests	Plat. 20%	Markup	Overhead	Net
0 ✓	K0	K3,366	K2,936	+K430
10	K371	K3,366	K2,936	+K801
20	K741	K3,366	K2,936	+K1,171
30	K1,112	K3,366	K2,936	+K1,542

Phase 4 — overhead K4,442 | break-even at 30 guests

Guests	Plat. 20%	Markup	Overhead	Net
30 ✓	K1,112	K3,366	K4,442	+K36
50	K1,853	K3,366	K4,442	+K777
100	K3,705	K3,366	K4,442	+K2,629
330 max	K12,227	K3,366	K4,442	+K11,151

✓ = phase break-even. Net = Plat. 20% + Markup − Overhead. Plat. 20% = guests × K195 × 95% × 20% = guests × K37.05. Team 60% = guests × K185.25 × 60% = guests × K111.15. Marketing 20% (guests × K37.05) flows directly to campaign — not shown here.

MILESTONES

Decision Points

Each milestone marks a threshold where the platform activates the next level of tooling. With K3,366 in monthly markup, Phases 1, 2, and 3 are all active from launch. Only Phase 4 requires guest revenue to unlock, at 30 guests.

Guests	Trigger	Action
0 (launch)	Campaign complete — 66 full members	Open course. Activate all tooling through Phase 3 immediately — K3,366 markup covers Phases 1, 2, and 3 from day 1
30	Phase 4 break-even	Upgrade manager Claude to $100 (K1,882/month). Net goes from +K1,542 to +K36 then builds
330	All slots filled	K11,151 net, team earning K39,898 — open waitlist for next course

GROWTH ENGINE

The Reinvestment Loop

Platform net income goes straight back into the flyer campaign — no extraction, no holding. Every month, the full net is converted to flyers at K15 effective cost (K10 print + K5 commission reserve). At a steady 10% conversion rate, the loop compounds automatically.

> **K150 net income → 10 flyers → 1 new full member → K51/month markup (permanent)**
>
> **Payback period: K150 ÷ K51 = under 3 months — then pure compounding**
>
> **Each month's net becomes next month's campaign budget.**
>
> **More members → higher markup → larger campaign → more members.**

At launch the net surplus is K430/month — small, but it funds 28 flyers and adds roughly 3 new members. Those 3 members add K153/month in markup, lifting the next month's net to K583. The month after: K583 buys 38 flyers, adds 4 more members, net rises to K787. The campaign never stops — it just gets bigger each cycle.

Month	Net into campaign	Flyers	New members	Cumul. members	Markup/month
Launch	K10,000 (seed)	666	66	66	K3,366
1	K430	28	3	69	K3,519
2	K583	38	4	73	K3,723
3	K787	52	5	78	K3,978
6	K1,858	123	12	106	K5,406

12-Month NPV Forecast — Conservative Assumptions

This forecast is deliberately built to underestimate profit and overestimate risk. If the platform performs to these numbers, it is already doing well. Real performance is expected to exceed them.

Discount rate: 25% p.a. (BOZ policy rate 13.25% plus a conservative 12% risk premium). Full member monthly churn: 7% — above the academic-subscription norm, below the general edtech benchmark of 8–15% (loyalty.cx). Guest monthly churn: 10%. Guest upgrade rate: 2%/month. New guests recruited by course team: 5 in Month 1, growing by 3 per month — a deliberately slow ramp. Flyer conversion held at 10%. All net income reinvested into campaign each month.

Mth	FM	Guests	Team 60%	Founders	Net	PV Net	Cumul. NPV
1	66	0	K0	K0	K430	K422	K422
2	64	5	K555	K185	K513	K494	K916
3	63	13	K1,445	K482	K759	K718	K1,634
4	64	23	K2,557	K852	K1,180	K1,095	K2,729
5	68	35	K3,890	K1,297	K323	K294	K3,023
6	78	47	K5,224	K1,741	K1,277	K1,142	K4,165
7	85	61	K6,780	K2,260	K2,153	K1,890	K6,055
8	100	77	K8,558	K2,853	K3,511	K3,026	K9,081
9	124	93	K10,337	K3,446	K5,328	K4,507	K13,588
10	159	111	K12,338	K4,113	K7,780	K6,460	K20,048
11	208	130	K14,450	K4,817	K10,983	K8,951	K28,999
12	275	149	K16,562	K5,520	K15,103	K12,082	K41,081

FM = full members at start of month. Team 60% = guests x K185.25 x 60%. Founders = Platform 20% of distributable (guests x K37.05) — extracted as personal income. Net = Marketing 20% + FM markup − overhead — stays in business, reinvests into campaign. Overhead K2,936 until 30 guests (Phase 4 triggers), then K4,442. Month 5 dips to K323 at Phase 4 trigger — never negative. Per founder: divide Founders column by 3. PV at 25% p.a. — DF = 1/(1.25)^(n/12). 12m undiscounted net: K49,340. NPV: K41,081.

> Conservative 12-month NPV at 25% p.a.: K41,081
> Undiscounted net over 12 months: K49,340
> Month 12: 275 FM, 149 guests, K15,103 net/month
> Always net positive — floor K323 in Month 5 (Phase 4 trigger).
> Higher churn, slower growth, 25% discount — real performance should exceed this floor.

> **The campaign is never a one-time spend. It is a permanent engine: net income in → flyers out → members in → more net → repeat. The K10,000 seed starts the loop. After that, the platform funds its own growth.**

ROLLOUT

Course Launch Sequence

No course opens without at least one confirmed guest commitment — this confirms real demand before hiring a manager. The threshold is low because the K3,366 markup already covers all overhead through Phase 3 from launch, including all four courses.

Course	Min. guests	Why
Course 1	1 committed	K3,366 markup > K1,054 overhead — profitable immediately
Course 2	1 committed	K3,366 > K1,393 (adds K339 manager seat) — still covered by markup
Course 3	1 committed	K3,366 > K1,732 (adds another K339) — still covered
Course 4	1 committed	K3,366 > K2,071 (adds third K339) — covered by markup, no guests required

> Rollout sequence:
> Campaign → 66 full members (330 guest slots unlocked)
> → Waitlist opens for Course 1
> → 1 guest committed → Course 1 launches, manager hired
> → Waitlist opens for Course 2
> → 1 guest committed → Course 2 launches, manager hired
> → Repeat for Courses 3 and 4
>
> At four courses running at full capacity: K64,350/month guest revenue per course.

TEAM

Course Team Structure

Each course has one matched team. The Manager handles everything for that course — content delivery, community management, and marketing. Sourcers bring in source material and student referrals. Manager and Sourcers apply for a specific course and are matched before launch. No person crosses courses.

> **Course team: 60% of distributable guest revenue (Manager 36% + Sourcers 24%)**
>
> **Marketing fund: 20% of distributable guest revenue → campaign**
>
> **Welfare: 5% of gross guest revenue (data, meals, transport — off the top)**
>
> **At 330 guests max: Course team K36,680 + Welfare K3,218 = K39,898 to team**

Welfare is not a fixed amount — it grows with the course. At 10 guests the pool is K98. At 200 guests it is K1,950. Data stays covered throughout. Meals and transport become meaningful as the course matures and in-person sessions become regular.

> **All platform overhead — founder Slack, founder Claude, manager Slack seat, manager Claude — is borne by the platform from its 20% share and the full member markup. The course team's 60% is never reduced by overhead at any stage.**

PAYMENT CADENCE

Weekly Team Payouts

Students pay monthly. The team gets paid weekly. Each student payment received during the week is split immediately and batched into a single Friday mobile money transfer to the Manager and Sourcers. No waiting until month-end.

> **Per student payment received:**
>
> **K195 × 5% = K9.75 welfare (team data/meals/transport pool)**
>
> **K195 × 95% = K185.25 distributable**
>
> **→ Marketing 20% = K37.05 (straight to campaign fund)**
>
> **→ Course team 60% = K111.15 (Manager + Sourcers)**
>
> **→ Platform 20% = K37.05 (retained by platform)**

Weekly Payout by Batch Size

If N students pay in the same week, multiply by N. Payments trickle across the month — some weeks are heavier than others. Pay what came in that week. Do not hold.

Guests paid	Gross	Welfare	Marketing	Team 60%	Platform
1	K195	K9.75	K37.05	K111.15	K37.05
5	K975	K48.75	K185.25	K555.75	K185.25
10	K1,950	K97.50	K370.50	K1,111.50	K370.50
20	K3,900	K195.00	K741.00	K2,223.00	K741.00
50	K9,750	K487.50	K1,852.50	K5,557.50	K1,852.50

Full member markup (K2,040/month) goes entirely to the platform and is not distributed weekly to the team. Transfer it to the platform account once per month as members pay their subscriptions.

> How to run it each Friday:
> 1. Open your payment log (WhatsApp thread or spreadsheet)
> 2. Sum all guest payments received Monday–Friday
> 3. Apply the formula: Gross × 95% × 60% → Course team
> 4. Transfer via Airtel/MTN Mobile Money — same day
> 5. Log: 'Week ending [date] — [N] payments — Manager K[X] sent ✓'
>
> Keep every transfer receipt. This is the record actual performance is measured against.

> **Weekly payments are motivating and low-risk. You only pay money already received — there is no float or advance. If a student is late paying, that week's batch is simply smaller. The formula never changes.**